

- Libre Office (Mac, Windows, Linux – Open Source)
- Google Docs (Cloud)
- Zoho (Cloud)
- ThinkFree (Cloud, Android)
- NeoOffice (Mac OSX)

Part of the challenge of developing productivity software is creating features that are easy to use and novel. Users can be very picky about certain features necessitating intuitive features which shouldn't take too much effort getting used to.

We've seen a trend of some companies choosing to create Open Source software while others stick to their proprietary software. The latest trend is the gradual shift towards online productivity suites from traditional desktop software. Which of these tools is likely to work better for you? Let's find out...

Features

First up, let's look at the differences in features of both, online productivity suites and desktop productivity suites. Most traditional office suites have developed a bunch of advanced features over the years, and organisations that have gotten used to them will find them hard to replace. Online tools might work okay with standard documents such as reports, memos, presentations etc. but they don't offer the more sophisticated features of their desktop counterparts. Features such as easy formatting or detailed control over fonts – stuff many tech savvy users usually rely on – wouldn't necessarily be present online. In general, desktop applications can be typecast to be more robust than their online counterparts. No online office suite will give you the complete functionality of an installed suite. However, it can provide all the basic features an average user might need and then some. And if you aren't sure whether or not an online suite is right for you, just upload a document and check out whether it includes all the features that you're comfortable with.

Access & Compatibility

One attractive aspect of online suites is the fact that you can access them from any computer connected to the internet. This is a huge advantage, since you can access and work on your information from anywhere with an internet connection. So as long as you have a relatively decent internet connection, you should be good to go. Most web service applications are interoperable across multiple platforms, thus giving them an edge when